Little Fox Readers

Level 5

Journey to the West 84
The Sad King



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The Sad King



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I wish I had money," Bajie moaned. "All this food looks so good."

The travelers were walking through a city in the Scarlet Kingdom. The streets were lined with people selling food and other goods.

"Stop thinking about food, Bajie," said Wujing.

"What's going on over there?" asked the Tang Monk. He pointed to a crowd of people reading a sign on a wall.

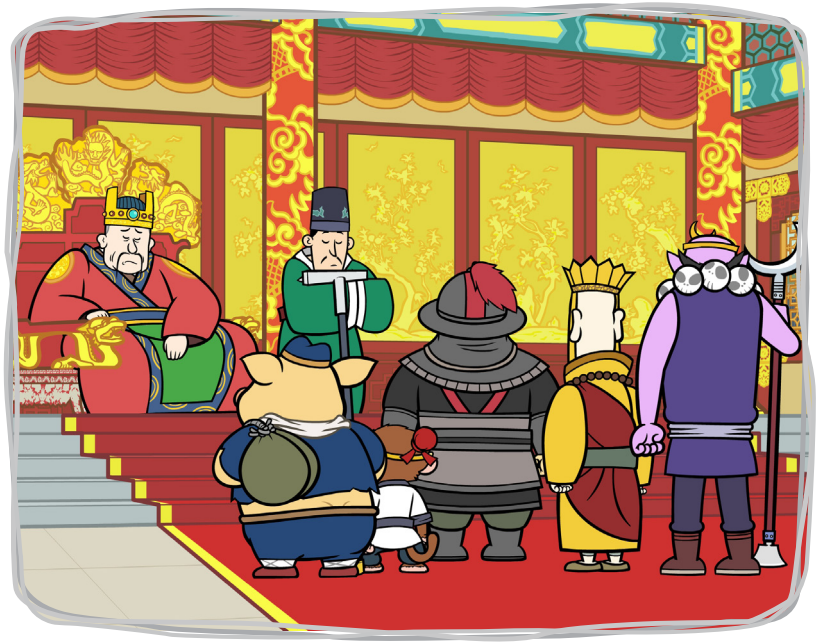


The travelers walked over to the crowd.

The sign read: "The King of the Scarlet Kingdom is seeking help. Anyone who can defeat demons must report to the royal palace."

The Tang Monk sighed. "I don't want to delay our journey. But you three can defeat demons. We must report to the palace."

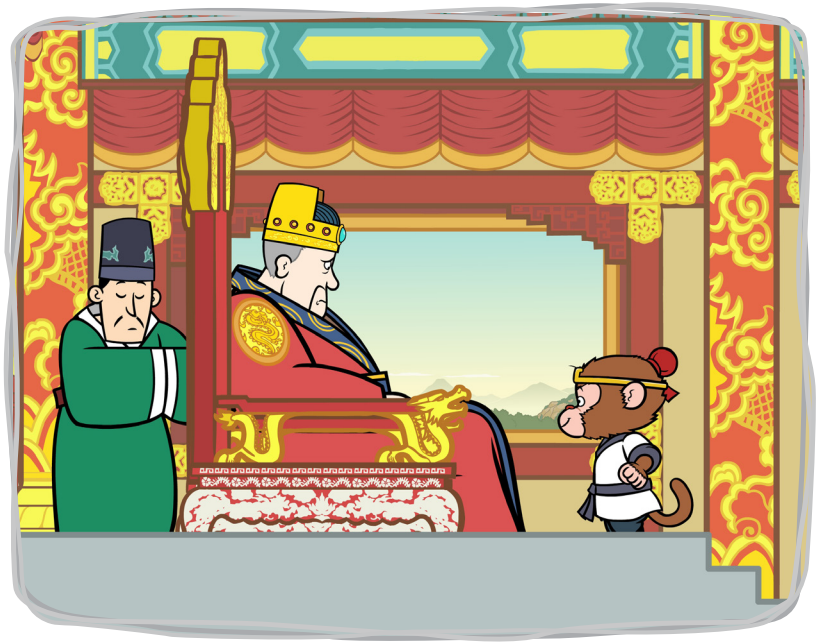
"Don't worry, Master," said Wukong. "I'm great at defeating demons. This won't take long."



“I hope they have food at the palace,” said Bajie. “I’m starving.”

The travelers arrived at the palace gate. They spoke with a guard, who then led them into the court. The king sat on his throne, looking very sad.

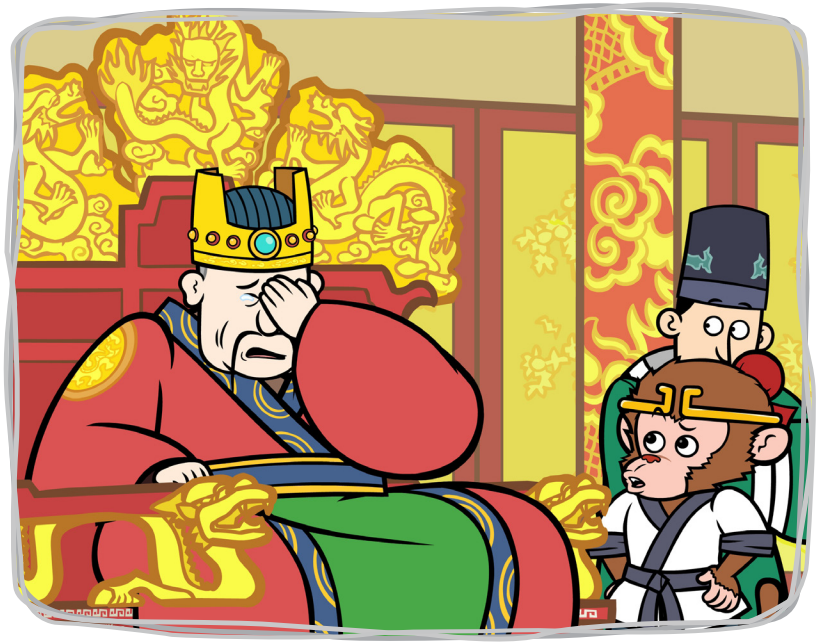
“Your Majesty,” said the guard. “The Tang Monk is here to see you. He says his companions can defeat demons.”



The king looked up but didn’t say anything.

The guard whispered to the travelers. “His Majesty is very upset. If you can help him, please do.”

Wukong walked up to the king. “Greetings, Your Majesty. I am Sun Wukong, king of the Fruit and Flower Mountain. You need someone who can defeat demons. Well, here I am!”



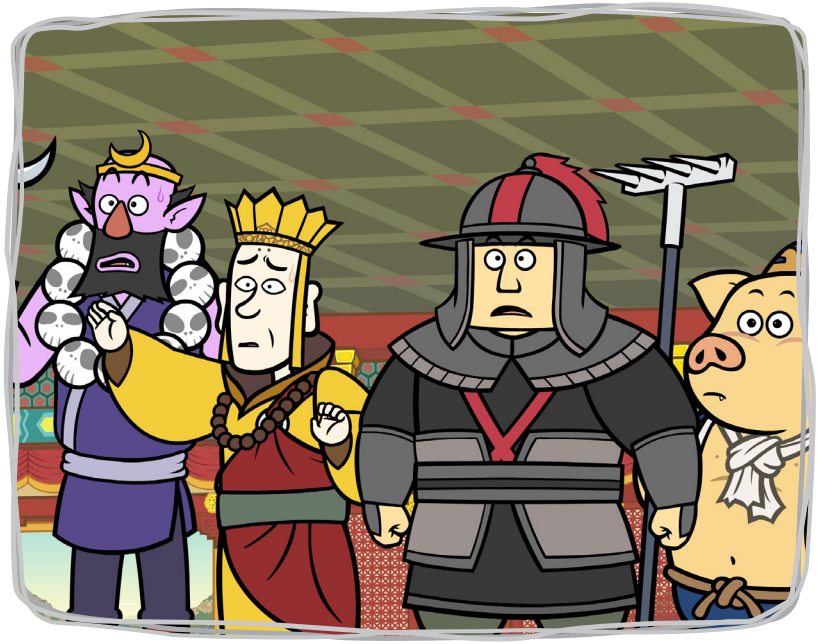
Suddenly the king covered his face with his hands and burst out crying.

"Oh, it's terrible!" cried the king. "I have no hope anymore!"

Wukong scratched his head. "What's wrong?"

"The queen—my wife!" cried the king. "I'll never . . . Oh! It's terrible!"

Wukong frowned. "Your Majesty, stop crying!"



"Wukong!" hissed the Tang Monk. "Show some respect."

Wukong ignored the monk and looked at the king. "I realize you're upset. But if you want my help, you must stay calm and explain everything to me."

The king sniffed and sat up straight. "You're right." He pulled out a handkerchief and blew his nose. "I will tell you what happened.



Three years ago the Demon of Power attacked our kingdom. The demon kidnapped the queen. I sent soldiers to fight the demon and bring back my wife. But the demon was too powerful."

"Where is the demon?" asked Wukong.

The king got up and walked to a window. He pointed to a mountain in the distance. "The demon lives on that mountain."

Wukong clapped the king on the back.



"You can stop being sad now, Your Majesty. I will rescue the queen. In the meantime, please take care of my companions. I think Bajie is hungry."

* * *

Wukong landed on the demon's mountain. Several small demons were standing outside a cave entrance.



"Return the queen or I'll destroy all of you!" shouted the monkey.

"Ahh!" cried the small demons as they ran into the cave.

Wukong heard another voice inside the cave. "What's going on?" it said.

"Master!" cried one demon. "There's a monkey outside. We must return the queen, or he'll destroy all of us!"



A large demon with broad shoulders came out of the cave. He wore three bells.

"I am the Demon of Power!" shouted the demon. "Get off of my mountain!"

Wukong was furious. "Do you know who I am? I'm the—"

Whoosh! Flames shot all over, smoke filled the air, and sand whipped past Wukong.



The monkey coughed as sand flew up his nose.

“This is awful!” cried Wukong.

He covered his face and leaped off the mountain.